AssetX — UX Blueprint

Version: 0.1 — MVP design foundation
Product: B2B marketplace for surplus and used electronics in Egypt
Based on: The attached AssetX Project Documentation v1.0

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1. Product experience summary

AssetX connects companies with surplus electronic equipment to companies looking for reliable equipment at a lower cost. The experience should not feel like a general classifieds site. It should feel like a trustworthy B2B marketplace where buyers can understand an asset's condition, seller, transaction model, and next step.

Core promise: Discover equipment from verified companies, or sell your company's assets through fixed-price listings, auctions, or requests for quotation (RFQs)—with clear steps and transaction status.

Scope note: The project documentation excludes an Arabic interface from the MVP. The initial product UI is therefore recommended in English, while its design system should be prepared for future Arabic and RTL support. This document is in English for implementation and handoff.

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2. UX principles

1. **Trust before persuasion:** Show company verification status, the simulated-payment limitation, and what happens after a purchase or bid.
2. **Make every transaction legible:** Users should always know whether an item is reserved, whether payment is simulated/held, and who needs to act next.
3. **Make selling easy for companies:** Use an asset-focused listing flow that supports quantities and batches without requesting unnecessary information.
4. **Keep transaction models distinct:** Fixed price, auction, and RFQ should have clear labels and different primary actions.
5. **Make system states visible:** Pending verification, pending review, reserved, and disputed should be understandable statuses, not technical errors.
6. **Be honest about the MVP:** Explain that payments are simulated and handover happens outside the platform. Do not imply real escrow or logistics.
7. **Design responsively and accessibly:** Support desktop and mobile, keyboard navigation, clear field labels, and sufficient contrast.

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3. Users and needs

Buyer — startup or SME

- Wants to find suitable equipment quickly and compare condition, price, quantity, and location.
- Needs evidence that the seller is a verified company.
- Needs to understand the steps and risks before committing, especially for auctions and simulated payments.
- **Success signal:** Finds a suitable asset and completes the intended action without confusion or premature off-platform coordination.

Seller — IT, operations, or procurement lead

- Wants to recover value from surplus inventory with minimal effort.
- Needs to publish a single asset or batch and track listing review, buyer interest, and transactions.
- Needs to understand why a listing was rejected and how to resubmit it.
- **Success signal:** Submits a complete listing that is approved and can manage the next steps from one dashboard.

Company user awaiting verification

- Wants to create an account and understand what is missing before they can buy or sell.
- **Success signal:** Completes verification and can see the current status and next step without hitting a dead end.

Platform administrator

- Needs clear queues for company verification, listing review, auction/RFQ monitoring, and disputes.
- Needs an audit trail and reasons for sensitive actions, plus a warning before suspending a company with active transactions.

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4. Proposed information architecture

Visitor experience

- Home / Marketplace
- Marketplace / All assets
- Asset details
- Company profile
- How it works / Trust and simulated payment
- Sign in and company registration

Company workspace

- Dashboard
- Marketplace and search
- Watchlist (optional if capacity allows)
- My listings
- Create listing / asset batch
- Auctions and my bids
- RFQs: My requests / Relevant requests / Submitted offers
- Transactions and disputes
- Notifications
- Company settings and verification status

Admin workspace

- Overview
- Company verification queue
- Listing review queue
- Auction and RFQ monitoring
- Companies and accounts
- Transactions and disputes

Desktop navigation: Persistent top bar for search, notifications, and account; a side navigation for the company workspace. On mobile, collapse navigation into a compact menu or bottom navigation while keeping the primary action prominent.

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5. Core user flows

A. Company registration and verification

1. Visitor selects **Create company account**.
2. Enters work email, password, and basic company details.
3. Confirms email.
4. Enters the company workspace with **Verification pending** status. A banner explains that browsing is available, while listing, bidding, and purchasing require verification.
5. Submits the documents/information requested by operations (the exact requirements must be decided; they are not specified in the source documentation).
6. Sees a status: In review / More information required / Verified / Rejected, with a reason and next step.

UX requirement: Do not let users discover eligibility limits only after clicking Buy. Show eligibility near relevant actions from the start.

B. Fixed-price search and purchase

1. Buyer starts in the marketplace and searches by keyword or filters by subcategory, condition, location, and price range.
2. Reviews result cards and sorts by price, newest, or auction closing time where relevant.
3. Opens an asset detail page: images, description, condition, quantity, location, price, sale type, company, and verification badge.
4. Selects **Buy**. A confirmation view summarizes the asset and price and explains that payment is simulated and handover is off-platform.
5. After confirmation, the asset becomes **Reserved**. The transaction shows **Payment held (simulated)** and clearly identifies the next step for each party.
6. Buyer confirms receipt; the transaction completes and the asset becomes **Sold**.

Exceptions: Asset already reserved/sold, simulated payment failure, or cancellation before the reservation is finalized. Explain the reason and available action.

C. Bidding in an auction

1. Auction page shows current price, minimum next bid, closing time in local time, bid count, and the simulated deposit requirement.
2. Before the first bid, the buyer sees a short explanation of the refundable simulated deposit and confirms it.
3. Enters a bid amount; the UI validates amounts below the minimum before submission.
4. Confirms the bid, then sees an immediate receipt showing the amount and status (leading bidder / outbid).
5. Receives a notification when outbid.
6. At close, sees the outcome: Won / Did not win / Ended with no valid bids, plus the next step.

Decisions required before final UI: Deposit amount, increment calculation, refund rules, and what happens if the winner does not complete the purchase. Do not invent values in the interface.

D. Create an RFQ and receive offers

1. Buyer describes the need: device type, specifications, quantity, acceptable condition, location, budget (optional), and deadline.
2. Reviews the request and confirms publication to eligible companies.
3. Seller browses open RFQs and submits an offer including price, quantity, details, and validity period.
4. Buyer compares offers in a consistent table: verified company, price, condition, quantity, location, and offer validity.
5. Selects an offer; a confirmation view appears before the transaction is created and other sellers are notified.

States: No offers, deadline passed, request cancelled, company cannot bid on its own RFQ, and offer submitted after deadline.

E. Seller listing creation

1. Clear **Create listing** action.
2. Choose an individual listing or an asset batch (the source defines a batch as assets sold as one unit).

3. Multi-step form: asset information → photos and condition → quantity and location → sale type → price/auction settings → review.
4. Save as draft, with progress indication and field validation.
5. Submit for review; confirmation explains that it will not be public until Admin approval.
6. Listings dashboard shows Draft / Pending review / Published / Rejected / Withdrawn / Sold, with an appropriate action for each state.

Form guidance: Use examples inside fields rather than long instructions, identify required fields, support image preview, and preserve entered data after validation errors.

F. Dispute

1. From the transaction page, either party selects **Report a problem**.
2. Selects a reason, describes the issue, and adds evidence if uploads are in scope.
3. Reviews the impact of opening a dispute before submitting; transaction becomes **Disputed**.
4. Sees current status, latest update, and next step. After Admin resolution, both parties can see the outcome and reason.

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6. Priority screen inventory

P0 — Required for the pilot

1. Home/marketplace with search and filters.
2. Search results and asset cards.
3. Asset details (fixed-price and auction variants or a shared component).
4. Company registration, sign-in, and email confirmation.
5. Company profile and verification status.
6. Multi-step listing creation and preview.
7. Seller dashboard and listing status management.
8. Purchase confirmation and transaction details.
9. Auction page, bid submission, and bid outcome.
10. RFQ creation, details, offer list, and comparison.
11. Notifications and notification states.

12. Admin queues for verification, listing review, and disputes.

P1 — After MVP validation

- Watchlists and asset comparison.
- Saved searches and RFQ match alerts.
- Advanced seller performance analytics.
- Multiple users per company.
- In-platform chat or direct negotiation (not currently specified as MVP scope).

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7. Asset card specification

Cards should communicate at a glance:

- Clear primary image and image count when available.
- Asset name/model and electronics subcategory.
- Understandable condition label (e.g., new/used/needs repair; final values require a team-defined taxonomy).
- Price or current bid, with **Fixed price** or **Auction** label.
- Quantity and location.
- Company name and **Verified** badge.
- For auctions: time remaining and current bid; never rely on color alone to convey urgency.
- Clear **View details** action. Avoid direct purchase from the card to reduce accidental actions.

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8. UI states and messages

Design these states in addition to the ideal screens:

- Results loading, no results, load failure, and filters with no matches.
- Company unverified, pending review, more information required, verified, rejected, and suspended.
- Listing draft, pending review, published, rejected with reason, withdrawn, reserved, and sold.
- Auction not started, active, leading, outbid, ended/won, ended/lost, and ended without valid bids.

- RFQ open, offers received, deadline passed, cancelled, and offer selected.
- Transaction pending, simulated payment held, awaiting receipt confirmation, completed, cancelled, and disputed.
- Success/failure feedback for every action, with a next step and confirmation before irreversible actions.

Message pattern: Explain what happened + the impact + what the user can do. Example: “Your bid could not be placed because the current minimum is [amount]. Update your bid and try again.”

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9. Trust and transparency

- The verification badge indicates company review; it should not be presented as a guarantee of asset quality.
- The asset page explains that inspection/handover is handled by the parties outside the platform in the MVP.
- Before commitment, clearly summarize the amount and simulated flow; avoid language that implies real money is being charged.
- Show key status changes and transaction updates.
- Provide a clear way to report a problem and describe Admin’s role realistically.
- Do not make legal or protection promises that have not been approved by the team.

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10. Visual direction

Personality: Professional, practical, and trustworthy—closer to a B2B procurement workspace than a consumer shopping app.

- Neutral light background, dark high-contrast text, and one primary action color.
- Green/gray for success and verification, amber for caution, and red for errors; never use color alone to convey meaning.
- Give asset photos enough space to inspect condition, with a simple background and room for specifications.
- Make price, quantity, and time prominent. Confirm currency formatting (likely EGP) before final design.

- Build a consistent component system: buttons, badges, fields, cards, tables, confirmation dialogs, alerts, and empty states.
- Support responsive layouts, comfortable touch targets, and a readable RFQ comparison on mobile.

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11. Design validation plan

Before approving final UI, test a prototype with 5–8 people across both sides (buyers and sellers, and ideally one operations/Admin participant) using these tasks:

1. Find a laptop within a given budget and identify whether the company is verified.
2. Explain what happens after buying an asset at a fixed price.
3. Place a valid bid and explain what being outbid means.
4. Create an RFQ, compare two offers, and select one.
5. Create a listing, save it as a draft, then submit it for review.
6. Explain what **Payment held (simulated)** means and what happens next.

Measures: Task completion without help, time on task, errors, hesitation points, and users' understanding of verification, payment, and handover. Click success alone does not prove trust or policy clarity.

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12. Questions to resolve before final UI

1. Which company verification documents are required, and are they uploaded in-product?
2. Can one company act as both buyer and seller from the same account? (Requirements imply yes; recommended.)
3. What are the exact electronics subcategories and condition values?
4. Can a listing contain multiple units, or is it always one asset/batch sold as a single unit?
5. Which currency is displayed, and are any fees included in the shown price?
6. What is the simulated deposit amount and refund policy? What happens if the winner defaults?
7. How are contact details and handover arrangements shared between parties?
8. What is the receipt-confirmation deadline, and what happens if the buyer does not respond?

9. Is there messaging between parties, or are the first release interactions limited to offers and notifications?
10. What are the listing review criteria and standardized rejection reasons?

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13. Recommended implementation order

1. Start with flows and wireframes for the marketplace, asset details, listing creation, and verification.
2. Test the fixed-price journey first; the project documentation itself recommends fixed price, then RFQ, then auction to reduce scope risk.
3. Add RFQ with a simple, clear offer comparison.
4. Add auctions with documented end, outbid, and deposit states.
5. Design Admin and dispute workflows alongside transaction models, not as a late add-on.
6. After usability testing, create a reusable UI kit and hand it to engineering.

Recommended next deliverable: Convert this blueprint into wireframes for the core screens (desktop-first with responsive layouts), then test with Egyptian businesses before locking the visual design.